

UTT Series Book II: Apologetics Overview

Course Description: *Apologetics* is the second volume in the four-part Understanding the Times series, and uses Scripture and a Student Textbook as primary texts to:

- help students understand, experience, and live out the Christian worldview.
- guide students in sharing, defending, and commending the Christian faith to others.
- demonstrate how the Christian worldview stands up to common objections in society today.
- equip students with biblical teaching on topics including faith, pluralism, relativism, science, evil, hell, violence, science, gender, and more.

This course integrates the content with a review of the Bible's metanarrative and a defense of its trustworthiness to prepare students to share the gospel with sensitivity and critical thinking.

Chapter 1: Introduction

1. Ever Been There?
2. Purpose of this Book
3. The Bible and the Mission of God
4. The Call to Participate in the Mission of God
5. An Introduction to Evangelism and Apologetics
6. Some Misconceptions About Evangelism and Apologetics
7. Approaching Evangelism and Apologetics
8. The Limitation of Reason and the Role of Doubt
9. Some Questions of Apologetics
- 1.10 Conclusion

Chapter 2: A Trustworthy Bible

- 2.1 Encountering the Bible
- 2.2 What the Bible Is and Isn't
- 2.3 The Word of God through Humans
- 2.4 Is the Bible True?
- 2.5 Are There Myths and Scientific Inaccuracies in the Bible?
- 2.6 Evidence for the Historical Reliability of the Bible
- 2.7 How We Got the Bible—Part I
- 2.8 How We Got the Bible—Part II
- 2.9 Reading the Bible with an Open Mind
- 2.10 Conclusion

Chapter 3: The Shape of God's Story

- 3.1 The Power of Stories
- 3.2 The Bible as a Metanarrative
- 3.3 Act 1: Creation—God's Good World
- 3.4 Act 2: The Fall—Sin and Its Consequences
- 3.5 Act 3: Redemption Initiated—Israel
- 3.6 Interlude—The Second Temple Period
- 3.7 Act 4: Redemption Accomplished—Jesus
- 3.8 Act 5: Restoration Initiated—The Church
- 3.9 Act 6: Restoration Accomplished—New Creation
- 3.10 Conclusion

Chapter 4: Participating in God's Story

- 4.1 Who You Are Underneath
- 4.2 Staying Rooted in God's Love
- 4.3 Remembering Our True Story
- 4.4. Christian Mission: Being, Doing, and Telling
- 4.5 Evangelism, Discipleship, and Missions
- 4.6 Evangelism, Discipleship, and Missions in Action
- 4.7 Apologetics
- 4.8 Apologetics in Action
- 4.9 Learning from Paul
- 4.10 Conclusion

Chapter 5: Empowered to Love

- 5.1 The Church Faces Persecution
- 5.2 Empowered by the Holy Spirit
- 5.3 Motivated by Love
- 5.4 Spiritual Preparation
- 5.5 Intellectual Preparation
- 5.6 Emotional Preparation
- 5.7 A Loving Approach
- 5.8 A Loving Encounter
- 5.9 Planting, Watering, and Reaping
- 5.10 Conclusion

Chapter 6: Not All Is Faith in Love and War

- 6.1 A Reason to Reason
- 6.2 Logically Speaking
- 6.3 Critical Thinking
- 6.4 Fallacies, Part 1
- 6.5 Fallacies, Part 2
- 6.6 Fallacies, Part 3
- 6.7 Listening Goes a Long Way
- 6.8 Asking Questions
- 6.9 Employing Scripture with Love
- 6.10 Conclusion

Chapter 7: What to Do with Doubt

- 7.1 Experiencing Doubt
- 7.2 The Nature of Faith
- 7.3 Doubt and Unbelief
- 7.4. Deconstruction and Reconstruction
- 7.5 Doubt and the Intellect
- 7.6 Doubt and Emotions
- 7.7 Doubt and Experience
- 7.8 Doubt and Our Actions
- 7.9 Attending to Doubt
- 7.10 Conclusion

Chapter 8: Truth and Tolerance

- 8.1 What Is Truth?
- 8.2 The Nature of Truth
- 8.3 The Necessity of Trust
- 8.4 A Christian View of Truth
- 8.5 Modernism: Truth Is Found through Reason and Science
- 8.6 Postmodernism: Truth Cannot Be Known
- 8.7 Relativism: Truth Is Individual and Cultural
- 8.8 A Christian Response to Other Views of Truth
- 8.9 Tolerance
- 8.10 Conclusion

Chapter 9: Religion Roundup

- 9.1 Does Religious Truth Matter?
- 9.2 Religious Terminology
- 9.3 Religious Pluralism
- 9.4 Critiquing Misguided Notions of Religious Pluralism
- 9.5 Religions of the World, Part 1
- 9.6 Religions of the World, Part 2
- 9.7 Religions of the World, Part 3
- 9.8 Fruitful Interreligious Dialogue
- 9.9 Case Study: A Dialogue with a Muslim
- 9.10 Conclusion

Chapter 10: Questioning Religion

- 10.1 The Nones
- 10.2 Foundational Nonreligious Worldviews
- 10.3 Religion and Reality
- 10.4 Religion and Reason
- 10.5 Religion and Human Flourishing
- 10.6 Religion and Meaning
- 10.7 Religion and Morality
- 10.8 Religion and Relationship
- 10.9 True Religion and Right Worship
- 10.10 Conclusion

Chapter 11: The Supernatural and Truth

- 11.1 Supernatural Encounters
- 11.2 Existence of God: Kalam Cosmological Argument
- 11.3 Existence of God: Design Argument
- 11.4 Existence of God: Moral Argument
- 11.5 Existence of the Christian God
- 11.6 The Possibility of Miracles
- 11.7 The Resurrection Miracle: Four Facts Plus One
- 11.8 The Resurrection Miracle: Confronting Alternative Theories
- 11.9 Existence of Other Supernatural Beings
- 11.10 Conclusion

Chapter 12: Christianity and Science

- 12.1 Introduction
- 12.2 The Relationship between Christianity and Science
- 12.3 Christianity and the Development of Modern Science
- 12.4 Science, the Bible, and the Church
- 12.5 The Nature of the Universe
- 12.6 The Science of Origins
- 12.7 Four Christian Views of Origins
- 12.8 The Nature of Human Life and Death
- 12.9 The Science of Health and Medicine
- 12.10 Conclusion

Chapter 13: Evil and Suffering

- 13.1 Facing the Darkness
- 13.2 Framing the Problem of Evil and Suffering
- 13.3 Evil Is Everyone's Problem
- 13.4 Free Will and the Origin of Evil
- 13.5 God's Foreknowledge and Sovereignty
- 13.6 Evil as a Personal Problem
- 13.7 God With Us
- 13.8 Victory over Evil
- 13.9 The Church's Response to Evil
- 13.10 Conclusion

Chapter 14: Hell

- 14.1 What's the Deal with Hell?
- 14.2 The Concept of Hell in Scripture
- 14.3 The Concept of Hell throughout Church History
- 14.4 What Is the Purpose of Hell?
- 14.5 How Long Does Hell Last?
- 14.6 Is Hell a Choice?
- 14.7 Is Hell Just?
- 14.8 What about Children and Those Who Haven't Heard?
- 14.9 Talking about Hell
- 14.10 Conclusion

Chapter 15: Slavery, Racism, and Violence in the Bible

- 15.1 A Troubling Scripture
- 15.2 The Descriptive and the Prescriptive
- 15.3 Cultural Context and Redemptive Movement
- 15.4 Slavery in the Old Testament
- 15.5 Slavery in the New Testament
- 15.6 Violence: When God Does It
- 15.7 Violence: When God Commands It
- 15.8 Violence: When God's People Pray for It
- 15.9 Violence: When Jesus Teaches about It
- 15.10 Conclusion

Chapter 16: Gender and the Bible

- 16.1 Introduction
- 16.2 Postmodernism, Technology, and Sexuality
- 16.3 Created as Embodied Souls
- 16.4 The Meaning of Marriage
- 16.5 Fallen People, Fallen Bodies
- 16.6 Sexual Orientation and Gender
- 16.7 The Fall and Sexual Brokenness
- 16.8 Redeemed and Resurrected Bodies
- 16.9 Sexuality and the Church
- 16.10 Conclusion

Chapter 17: Being a Faithful Witness

- 17.1 Developing a Personal Apologetic Approach
- 17.2 Pray
- 17.3 Become Equipped
- 17.4 Be Strategic
- 17.5 Be Winsome
- 17.6 Persevere
- 17.7 Practice
- 17.8 Reflect
- 17.9 Next Steps
- 17.10 Conclusion

Chapter 18: Conclusion

- 18.1 Scripture and the Mission of God
- 18.2 Participating in God's Mission with Confidence and Joy
- 18.3 Five Challenges to the Christian Faith
- 18.4 Four More Challenges to the Christian Faith
- 18.5 Engaging at the Worldview Level